

Ceramic

BRAND GUIDELINES

Product-forward.
AI-native.
Human-centered.

The founding team you didn't hire — and the look, language, and logic behind the brand.

CERAMIC LLC • New York
hello@ceramic.nyc

VERSION 1.0
AUGUST 2026

01 Who we are

Ceramic is a small, senior team that embeds into one organization and becomes its product-and-engineering function for the engagement. Greenfield AI and end-to-end software we own the outcome on — not a platform we're paid to install.

Independent, tech-agnostic, and deliberately scarce: two or three engagements a year. The scarcity is the product. We borrow the language of the forward-deployed-engineer wave for context, then refuse the label — we're the opposite of staff augmentation.

FORWARD-DEPLOYED

- An engineer shipped in from a big vendor
- Lands a predetermined platform
- Scales on volume — hundreds of seats
- You're one account of many

CERAMIC

- + The whole founding team, embedded
- + Tech-agnostic — solves the human problem
- + Scarce & bespoke — 2–3 a year
- + Total ownership of the outcome

How we say it

Not an engineer we send in. **The founding team you didn't hire.**

The frontier labs will send you forward-deployed engineers. **We become your company for a quarter.**

Bespoke AI, built into the core of how you work — **by the team that owns the outcome**, not the vendor that owns the platform.

Let us be **your force multiplier.**

02 Logo

The wordmark is Ceramic set in Encode Sans Condensed SemiBold with tight optical tracking. White on the dark gradient is primary; black on light neutral is the alternate.



Ceramic

PRIMARY · white on dark



Ceramic

ALTERNATE · black on light

DO

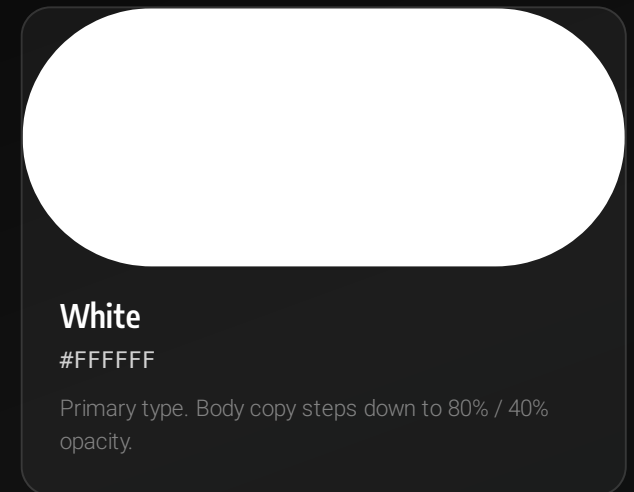
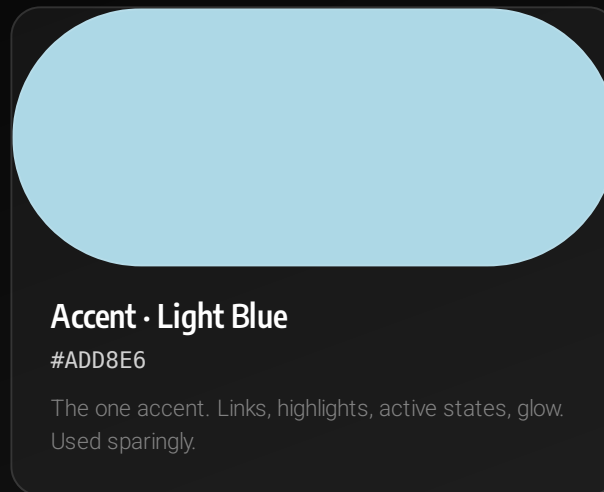
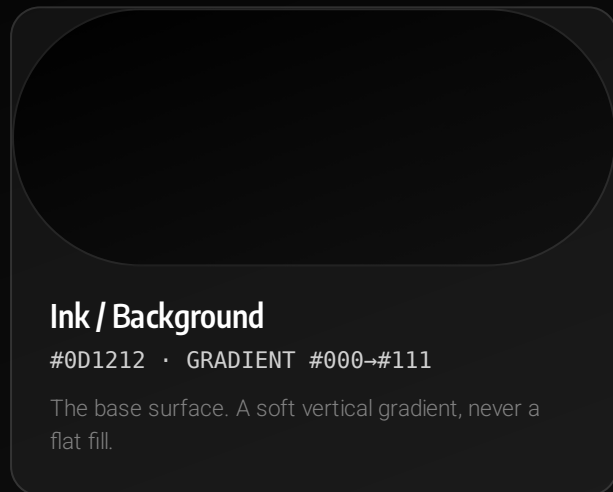
- + Keep clear space of at least the cap-height on every side.
- + Lead with white on the dark gradient canvas.
- + Anchor it quietly — top-left, small, confident.
- + Scale proportionally; 80px+ wide in headers.

DON'T

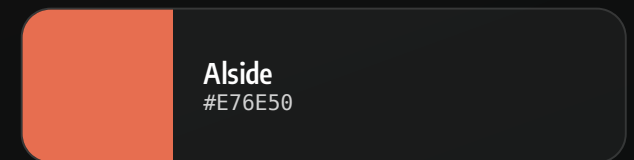
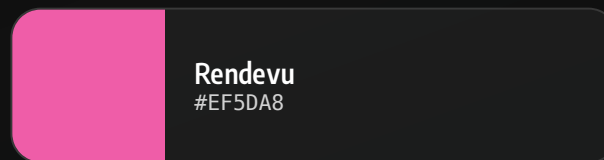
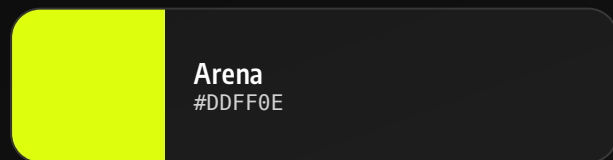
- Recolor it in the accent or a project color.
- Stretch, re-track, or re-weight the letterforms.
- Add shadows, outlines, or gradients to the mark.
- Set it on busy imagery without a dark scrim.

03 Color

A near-black canvas, white type, and a single cool accent — light blue — carrying all the emphasis. Everything else is white at varying opacity.



Project accents



Each case study carries one signal color, used only for that project's title and nav marker. They're punctuation — never part of the core palette.

Typography

Encode Sans Condensed

AaBbCc 0123 — condensed, tight, heavy

DISPLAY • 600 SemiBold • 700 Bold • 800 ExtraBold • every
headline & label

Roboto Light

AaBbCc 0123 — quiet, neutral, legible

BODY • 300 Light • fallback Helvetica, sans-serif

Dual CTOs. Product-forward.

TITLE • Encode 700 • up to 10rem • line-height .75 • tracking $-.3\text{rem}$ SUBTITLE • Encode 700 • 6rem • with hairline rule

We build with intent. Every decision is measured against real user needs and business impact.

STANDFIRST • Encode light • 1.5rem BODY • Roboto 300 • white/80 • 0.875rem

Voice & tone

Confident, terse, and a little wry. Craft language over corporate. The name is a material — expect heat, kiln, and glaze. We say what we do plainly, then undercut the swagger with a wink.

01

Product-forward

We build with intent. Every decision measured against real user needs and business impact.

02

AI-native

Old-school craft, new-school tools. Engineering rigor fused with AI-powered execution.

03

Human-centered

Technology serves people. We augment human capability — we don't replace it.

Signature phrases

Force multiplier

Do more with less

Skip the hype

No death by process

Unapologetically human

We come in hot

The rule

Short declaratives. A craft or material metaphor where it lands. One dry joke per page — see the footer: "No BPA, PFAS, lots of heavy metal." Never buzzword stacks, never hype for its own sake, never "forward-deployed."

Ceramic

**Let us be
your force multiplier.**

Do more with less. You decide on the footprint — together we can tackle any idea from conception to delivery and beyond.

Ceramic

Joey · Ceramic
hello@ceramic.nyc
ceramic.nyc

Email signature

Ceramic

Product-forward. AI-native. Human-centered.
hello@ceramic.nyc

LET'S BUILD

**Do more
with less.**

hello@ceramic.nyc